



AIMS26

Ai for Multimodal Science

June 23-25, 2026

UC SAN DIEGO



aims-2026.vercel.app



Welcome

ABOUT AIMS26

AIMS2026 (AI for Multimodal Science) is a three-day interdisciplinary workshop that brings together Schmidt Science Fellows from around the world and UC San Diego postdoctoral researchers to explore how multimodal artificial intelligence can accelerate discovery across scientific domains.

Multimodal AI sits at the forefront of modern research, enabling the integration of heterogeneous data types—such as images, time series, text, graphs, and simulations—to address complex scientific questions. These methods cut across biology, medicine, climate science, physics, materials science, and computer vision, where insights increasingly emerge from the fusion of multiple data modalities rather than from any single source alone.

While scientific datasets are often domain-specific, the core principles of multimodal fusion are broadly transferable. AIMS2026 emphasizes both [data-level multimodality](#) and [architecture-level multimodality](#). By focusing on generalizable fusion patterns and model designs, the workshop equips participants with approaches that can be readily adapted across disciplines—simply by swapping in their own domain's data, tasks, and evaluation metrics.

Through a combination of lectures, hands-on sessions, and collaborative discussions, AIMS2026 aims to foster a shared technical language for multimodal AI in science, build cross-domain connections among early-career researchers, and empower participants to apply state-of-the-art multimodal methods to their own research challenges.

Event Details

WORKSHOP AT-A-GLANCE

DATES	June 23–25, 2026
MAIN VENUE	UC San Diego, Seventh College Tower West, 15th Floor, Room 15A
HOTEL	San Diego Marriott La Jolla
MAIN SESSIONS	Faculty/industry talks, coding tutorials, hackathon, lightning talks, alternative activities
EVENING EVENTS	Sandbox tour, free evening, awards dinner reception
EVENT WEBSITE	https://aims-2026.vercel.app/

PLACES TO VISIT NEAR UCSD / LA JOLLA

[UC SAN DIEGO CAMPUS MAP >](#)

[Campus shuttle](#) [Live Shuttle Stracker](#)

On Campus

- The Stuart Collection: [22 Artworks](#) throughout the campus
- [Geisel Library - Iconic 1970 design](#)
- [UC San Diego Bookstore](#) for US San Diego goods and more
- [University Centers Dining & Retail](#)
- [Places to Eat at UCSD](#)

Near Campus

- [Torrey Pines Gliderport, Cliffhanger Cafe and Bar](#) (*Good for Sunset View*)
- [Birch Aquarium at Scripps](#) (*Good Ocean View*)
- La Jolla Shores Beach (*Good for Sunset View*)
- [UTC Mall](#) (*Near Marriott Hotel*)

VENUE INFORMATION

Wi-Fi

UC San Diego guest Wi-Fi information will be provided during check-in.

Emergency / Workshop Contact

aims26.ucsd@gmail.com

Attendees

ORGANIZERS

Yasmin Kassim

Executive Lead Organizer

University of California San Diego
Schmidt AI Fellow

Xiaoyu Zhao

Communications & Registration Lead

University of California San Diego
Schmidt AI Fellow

Eleonora Rachtman

Tutorials and Materials Lead

University of California San Diego
Schmidt AI Fellow

Uri Manor

Senior Scientific Advisor and Partnership lead

University of California San Diego
Assistant Professor

Konstantinos Polyzos

Hackathon and Data Lead

University of California San Diego
Schmidt AI Fellow

Tommie Velasquez

Administrative Coordination Lead

University of California San Diego
Academic Program Manager Sandbox

SPEAKERS

Tara Javidi

*Professor of Electrical &
Computer Engineering*
UC San Diego

Francisco Robles

Adjunct Assistant Professor
St Jude Children's Research Hospital

Rose Yu

Associate professor
UC San Diego Department
of Computer Science

Shalin Mehta

Group Leader
Chan Zuckerberg Biohub

James Zou

Associate Professor
Stanford University

Ulugbek Kamilov

*Professor of Electrical
and Computer Engineering*
University of Wisconsin–Madison

David Van Valen

*Assistant Professor, Division of
Biology and Bioengineering*
Caltech

Aaron Gilad Kusne

Staff Scientist
National Institute of Standards
and Technology

Jeff Gagnon

*Director of the Warren College
Writing Program*
University of California San Diego

Amin Barhoush

Founder & Technology Executive

Haider Ali

Founder & Technology Executive

Maya Gosztyla

Co-Founder
BrainStorm Therapeutics

PARTICIPANTS

Chris Anderson

University of California San Diego

Ibraheem Al Shammaa

University of California, Berkeley

Rory Basinski-Ferris

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Avik Biswas

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Hemanth Bodala

University of California San Diego

Weiwei Chen

Cornell University

Schmidt AI Fellow

Hannah Craddock

University of California San Diego

Carla Calvó-Tusell

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Roya Moghaddasi Fereidani

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Betul Beyza Gunes

University of California San Diego

Harsha Gouda

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Leire Luque García

University of California San Diego

Georgios Valogiannis

University of Chicago

Schmidt AI Fellow

Guido Herrera

Cornell University

Schmidt AI Fellow

Zhijian Hu

University of California San Diego

Dan Jiadong

National University of Singapore

Schmidt AI Fellow

Yinzhu Jin

University of California San Diego

Xiaofeng Liu

MIDAS, University of Michigan

Schmidt AI Fellow

Yasir Latif

Cornell University

Schmidt AI Fellow

Owen Leddy

University of California San Diego

Jiachen Li

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Stephane Loubrie

University of California San Diego

Radha Mastandrea

University of Chicago

Schmidt AI Fellow

Alexis Morales Flores

University of California San Diego

Mahesh Kumar Mulimani

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Yueying Ni

University of Michigan

Schmidt AI Fellow

Omolola Ogbolumani

University of Chicago,

Data Science Institute

Schmidt AI Fellow

Joseph Osumeje

University of Michigan

Schmidt AI Fellow

Ameya Pore

University of Toronto

Schmidt AI Fellow

Fnu Priyanka

University of California San Diego

Melissa Quinnan

University of California San Diego

Keivan Rahmani

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Shefali Rai

University of California San Diego

Marko Ristić

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Ulises Rosas-Puchuri

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Sandip Roy

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Rohan Singh Wilkho

Cornell University

Schmidt AI Fellow

Caden Stewart

University of California San Diego

Keshav Gupta

University of California San Diego

Xin Wei

University of Michigan

Schmidt AI Fellow

Raimon Padros I Valls

University of California San Diego

Seungmo Lee

University of California San Diego

Lily Weng

University of California San Diego

Zhen Wang

University of California San Diego

Yao Yu

University of California San Diego

Schmidt AI Fellow

Lindsey Young

University of California San Diego

Jingjing Zou

University of California San Diego

Vanessa ZoBell

University of California San Diego

Yuanhang Zhang

University of California San Diego

Xuhui Zhou

University of California San Diego

Jia Wang

University of California San Diego

Qi Su

University of California San Diego

AIMS 2026

Daily Schedule

AI for Multimodal Science | UC San Diego

June 23–25, 2026

Venue: UC San Diego, Seventh College – Tower West, 15th Floor, Room 15A

DAY 1 | TUESDAY, JUNE 23, 2026

TIME	SESSION	DETAILS
7:30 AM	Morning Shuttle Pickup	Pickup from San Diego Marriott La Jolla
7:50 AM	Shuttle Drop-off	Seventh College – Tower West
8:00 – 9:00 AM	Breakfast & Check-in	Light breakfast, badge distribution, and gift distribution
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Faculty / Industry Talks	Long-format talks: 45 minutes + 5 minutes Q&A each
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 1: Tara Javidi	Jacobs Family Scholar, Co-Founder & CTO at KavAI, Lewak Chair and Professor of Electrical & Computer Engineering, UC San Diego
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 2: Francisco Robles	Adjunct Assistant Professor, School of ECE, and Assistant Professor, Wallace H. Coulter Department of Biomedical Engineering, Georgia Tech and Emory

9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 3: Rose Yu	Associate Professor, UC San Diego Computer Science and Engineering; Amazon Scholar
12:00 – 1:00 PM	Lunch	Catered lunch and networking
1:00 – 2:30 PM	Demo / Coding Tutorial	See the Tutorial Schedule section
2:30 – 3:00 PM	Afternoon Break	Coffee, tea, juice, and light snacks
3:00 – 5:00 PM	Hackathon Track	Room 15B. Hackathon kickoff led by Konstantinos Polyzos. Participants begin team work on 3D reconstruction using multiple sensing modalities such as images, radar, and/or LiDAR
3:00 – 5:00 PM	Alternative Activity Track	Room 15A. Participant lightning talks highlighting multimodal AI results, ongoing work, datasets, or research challenges
5:00 PM	Formal Program Ends	Daily sessions conclude
5:30 – 7:00 PM	UCSD Sandbox Tour	Goeddel Family Technology Sandbox tour with dinner
7:15	Evening Shuttle Pickup	From Technology Sandbox, UC San Diego Bonner Hall
7:40	Shuttle Drop-off	San Diego Marriott La Jolla

DAY 2 | WEDNESDAY, JUNE 24, 2026

TIME	SESSION	DETAILS
7:30 AM	Morning Shuttle Pickup	Pickup from San Diego Marriott La Jolla
7:50 AM	Shuttle Drop-off	Seventh College – Tower West
8:00 – 9:00 AM	Breakfast & Check-in	Light breakfast and networking
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Faculty / Industry Talks	Long-format talks: 45 minutes + 5 minutes Q&A each, with short breaks
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 1: Shalin Mehta	Group Leader, Chan Zuckerberg Biohub
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 2: James Zou	Associate Professor, Stanford University
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 3: Ulugbek Kamilov	Leon and Elizabeth Janssen Associate Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, University of Wisconsin–Madison
12:00 – 1:00 PM	Lunch	Catered lunch and networking
1:00 – 2:30 PM	Demo / Coding Tutorial	See the Tutorial Schedule section
2:30 – 3:00 PM	Afternoon Break	Coffee, tea, juice, and light snacks
3:00 – 5:00 PM	Hackathon Track	Room 15B. Teams continue developing and iterating on multimodal 3D reconstruction pipelines
3:00 – 5:00 PM	Alternative Activity Track	Room 15A. Grant & Fellowship Writing – From Specific Aims to Storytelling, led by Jeff Gagnon
5:00 PM	Formal Program Ends	Daily sessions conclude

TIME	SESSION	DETAILS
5:30 PM	Evening Shuttle Pickup	From Seventh College – Tower West
5:50 PM	Shuttle Drop-off	San Diego Marriott La Jolla
Evening	Free Evening	No organized workshop event. Suggested informal option: sunset walk and ice cream at La Jolla beach

DAY 3 | THURSDAY, JUNE 25, 2026

TIME	SESSION	DETAILS
7:30 AM	Morning Shuttle Pickup	Pickup from San Diego Marriott La Jolla
7:50 AM	Shuttle Drop-off	Seventh College – Tower West
8:00 – 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Light breakfast and networking
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Faculty / Industry Talks + Lightning Talks	Two long-format talks followed by four participant lightning talks, 15 minutes each
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 1: David Van Valen	Assistant Professor, Division of Biology and Bioengineering, Caltech
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Speaker 2: Aaron Gilad Kusne	Staff Scientist, National Institute of Standards and Technology

TIME	SESSION	DETAILS
9:00 – 12:00 PM	Participant Lightning Talks	Four lightning talks by participants, 15 minutes each
12:00 – 1:00 PM	Lunch	Catered lunch and networking
1:00 – 2:30 PM	Demo / Coding Tutorial	See the Tutorial Schedule section
2:30 – 3:00 PM	Afternoon Break	Coffee, tea, juice, and light snacks
3:00 – 5:00 PM	Hackathon Track	Room 15B. Final hackathon development, demos, and preparation for awards
3:00 – 4:00 PM	Alternative Activity Track	Room 15A. Building Startups in the Era of Multimodal AI – Maya Gosztyla
4:00 – 5:00 PM	Alternative Activity Track	Room 15A. Building Startups in the Era of Multimodal AI – Amin Barhoush and Haider Ali
5:00 PM	Formal Program Ends	Daily sessions conclude
5:30 – 7:00 PM	Awards Ceremony & Dinner Reception	Hackathon awards ceremony, short demos, live audience voting, awards, special gifts, and closing dinner reception
7:30 PM	Evening Shuttle Pickup	From Seventh College – Tower West
7:50 PM	Shuttle Drop-off	San Diego Marriott La Jolla

Tutorial Schedule

June 23, 2026

Day 1 – Trustworthy & Interpretable AI

1:00 – 1:45 pm	Lily Weng University of California San Diego <i>Towards Trustworthy AI: A Principled Interpretability Perspective</i>
1:45 – 2:30 pm	Seungmo Lee University of California Los Angeles <i>Machine Learning for Genomics: From Sequence Features to Biological Insights</i>

June 24, 2026

Day 2 – Multimodal & Foundation Models

1:00 – 1:45 pm	Yueying Ni University of Michigan <i>Multimodal Learning for Galaxies: Contrastive and Generative Approaches</i>
1:45 – 2:30 pm	Radha Mastandrea University of Chicago <i>ContrAst: A Factorized Approach to Finetuning Multimodal Foundational Models for Astrophysical Data</i>

June 25, 2026

Day 3 – ML for Complex Systems

1:00 – 1:45 pm	Rohan Singh Wilkho Cornell University <i>What Are They Optimizing For? Inverse Reinforcement Learning for Inferring Hidden Objectives from Observed Decisions</i>
1:45 – 2:30 pm	Yasir Latif Cornell University <i>Machine Learning Analysis of North Atlantic Ocean Memory and Tropical Teleconnections</i>

Repository: <https://github.com/AIMS2026/Tutorials>

Lightning Talks Schedule

June 23, 2026

Day 1 – Lightning Talks

3:30 – 3:45 pm	Jingjing Zou	University of California San Diego	<i>Multimodal Learning for Wearable Health Data: From Raw Signals to Clinical Insight</i>
3:45 – 4:00 pm	Weiwei Chen	Cornell University	<i>Discover Multi-regional Neural Communication with Causal Representation Learning</i>
4:00 – 4:15 pm	Xuhui Zhou	University of California San Diego	<i>Neural Ensemble Kalman Filter: Data Assimilation for Compressible Flows with Shocks</i>
4:15 – 4:30 pm	Xin Wei	University of Michigan	<i>Unveiling the Underappreciated Consequences of Landslides across the United States with Generative AI</i>
4:30 – 4:45 pm	Joseph Osumaje	University of Michigan	<i>Bridging the Lithological Gap: A Foundation Model Approach to Groundwater Assessment in Northern Nigeria</i>
4:45 – 5:00 pm	Yuanhang Zhang	University of California San Diego	<i>Scientific Discovery as Meta-Optimization and Beyond: Towards End-to-End Auto-Research</i>

June 25, 2026

Day 3 – Lightning Talks

11:00 – 11:15 am	Ulises Rosas Puchuri	University of California San Diego	<i>Non-parametric Phylogenetic Regressions via Kernels</i>
11:15 – 11:30 am	Owen Leddy	University of California San Diego	<i>Multi-omics Data and Sample-efficient Model Architectures Improve Prediction of Bacterial T Cell Antigens</i>
11:30 – 11:45 am	Avik Biswas	University of California San Diego / Salk	<i>Towards Mechanistic Forecasting of Drug Resistance in RNA Viruses</i>

Repository: https://github.com/AIMS2026/Lightning_talks

Technology Sandbox Tour

Participants who registered for the evening social event, The UCSD Technology Sandbox Tour, will also be asked for your signature on the form of UC San Diego [Waiver of Liability, Assumption of Risk, and Indemnity Agreement \(2 pages\)](#). Those documents will be available at the registration.

The UCSD Technology Sandbox Tour will depart from Seventh College – Tower West at 5:00pm. The Technology Sandbox (9300 Eucalyptus Grove Ln, La Jolla, CA 92093) is located approximately a 20-minute walk from the workshop venue. Due to research laboratory requirements, photography will not be permitted inside the Technology Sandbox. We encourage you to take advantage of this opportunity to engage with [Dr. Uri Manor](#), Faculty Organizer of AIMS 2026 and Director of the Technology Sandbox. We invite you to ask questions and explore the unique vision and mission to support cutting-edge research, innovation, and education.

Dinner will be provided during the Technology Sandbox visit by [Tahini - UCSD/Kearny Mesa](#). Meal options include salad, rice, and meat dishes served with tahini sauce, which may contain nuts and onions.

The Technology Sandbox Tour is expected to conclude around 7:00pm. For participants staying at the San Diego Marriott La Jolla Hotel, the return shuttle will depart at 7:15pm.

If you have any questions about the sandbox visit, please feel free to contact Tommie Velasquez at t1velasquez@ucsd.edu.

Grant & Fellowship Writing: Telling Your Research Story for Maximum Impact

You have done meaningful, interesting research that has real stakes. Now you're seeking grants and fellowships and even job opportunities to keep doing it. But here's the reality: the people deciding whether to fund or hire you are reviewing dozens of proposals. They need to understand what you're doing, why it matters, who benefits, and why you're the person to do it. The best writing not only provides this information, but it uses powerful storytelling strategies to reach your audience.

This workshop teaches you how. Through hands-on exercises and small-group revision work, you'll practice opening with stakes, building clarity from complexity, and writing to different audiences.

This workshop is for postdocs and fellows who want their technical brilliance and their purpose to land the way it deserves.

Jeff Gagnon is a Writing Program Administrator at UC San Diego's Warren College, where he directs a writing program and coaches undergraduates, graduate students, and professionals across all disciplines, especially computer science, engineering, and the natural sciences. He helps researchers discover and articulate the human stakes of their work so it connects with the audiences who need to understand it.

Thank You & Stay Connected

Thank you for joining AIMS26: AI for Multimodal Science.

We are grateful to all speakers, participants, organizers, volunteers, and staff who helped make this workshop possible. We also thank Schmidt Sciences and UC San Diego for their generous support.

For the latest schedule, workshop resources, and updates, please visit:

<https://aims-2026.vercel.app/>

We welcome your feedback. Please feel free to email us at:

aims26.ucsd@gmail.com

Your input will help us improve future community events.

We look forward to staying connected and continuing the conversation beyond AIMS26.

The AIMS26 Organizing Team